

video footage captured from the lunar surface and much more.

Moon in Google Earth will also incorporate a complete lunar terrain data-set, which will serve as the atlas' base-map. Whether you are rediscovering the iconic moments in the history of moon exploration or learning about them for the first time, Moon in Google Earth will enable you to better understand the moon, and our relationship to it, with an immersive, 3D experience.

To experience Moon in Google Earth, open Google Earth 5.0 and switch mode from 'Earth' to 'Moon' on the top toolbar.

First mobile botnet discovered

Apart from being a serious problem for PCs, botnets are now targeting mobile phones. Security vendor Trend Micro has finally discovered what it claims to be the first botnet for mobile devices.

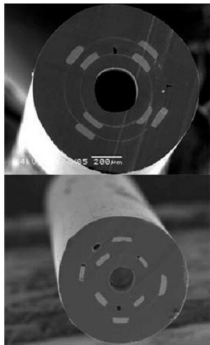
According to Trend Micro, the Symbian-based malware, labeled SYMBOS.XYXES.B, could be downloaded from malicious mobile sites by unsuspecting users. It targets the Symbian OS specifically.

A Symbian Information Source file collects phone and subscriber IDs and network information on affected devices, and connects to a website in order to send the information. In addition, it can send spammed SMS to the user's contacts acquired from the website it connected to earlier.

Trend Micro advises firms to ensure that all corporate mobile devices are protected with a firewall to block communications with the back-end site, along with SMS spam protection, data encryption and URL filtering.

Fabric that acts as a camera

Imagine a soldier's uniform made of a special fabric that allows him to look in all directions and identify threats that are to his side or even behind him. In a work that could turn such science fiction into reality, researchers at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) have developed light-detect-



A micrograph showing the cross-section of a new optoelectronic fibre

ing fibres that, when weaved into a web, act as a flexible camera. Fabric composed of these fibres could be joined to a computer that could provide information on a small display screen attached to a visor, providing the soldier greater awareness of his surroundings.

The researchers, led by associate professor Yoel Fink, emphasise that while such an application and others like it are still only dreams, work is rapidly progressing on developing fabrics capable of capturing images. In a recent issue of journal *Nanoleters*, the team reported the use of such a fibre web to take a rudimentary picture of a smiley face.

Fink's team placed the smiley face between a light source and a small swatch of fabric composed of the fibres, which was, in turn, connected to an external amplifying electrical circuit and computer. The individual fibres measured the intensity of the light illuminating

them and converted it into an electrical signal. Importantly, the fibres are also designed to differentiate between light at different wavelengths or colours. A mesh of fibres was then deployed to measure light intensity distribution at different wavelengths across a large area.

In the demo, the smiley face was illuminated with light at two separate wavelengths. This generated a distinct pattern on the fabric mesh, which was then fed into a computer. From there, an algorithm assimilated the data to create a black-and-white image of the object on a computer screen.

Cellphone towers can predict big floods

Cellphone towers could be used as a reliable method to predict the intensity of the next big flood. Researchers at the Tel Aviv University in Israel have developed a model which analyses cellphone signals, adding a critical component to weather forecasting.

Cellphone towers emit radio waves, which are diminished by moisture in the air—a factor that can be used to improve warnings on flood levels. Furthermore, TAU researchers measured the rainfall distributions and were able to accurately estimate the size of impending floods before they struck.

CRT recycling using laser

Panasonic has developed a recycling technology using laser beams to separate the front panel and back part (funnel) of a cathode ray tube (CRT)



Panasonic CRT recycling technology